2.7 Officials and Committees in State Legislative Assembly

Speaker of the State Legislative Assembly:

The Speaker is elected by the Members of Legislative Assembly itself, and is the Presiding Officer of the Assembly. The Speaker has the responsibilities and powers of conducting business of the assembly in orderly manner, maintaining decorum and regulating its procedure in terms of allowing the members to question, speak on matters of importance, budget and grants. The Speaker is the interpreter of the provisions of the Constitution, rules of procedure in the assembly proceedings, rules of procedure and legislative precedents within the Assembly. The Speaker has the power to adjourn, suspend and resume the sessions and suspend the members from participating in the session when there is a violation of rules, procedures and regulations of the assembly.

The Speaker has to generally maintain neutrality and impartiality while conducting the business of the house. The Speaker's vote becomes more important when there is a tie on any issue regarding passing of bill, motion and resolutions. The Speaker's decision is final in regulating the conduct of members and in matters of procedure or maintaining order in the house. And in such matters the Speaker is not to be subjected to judicial intervention. The Speaker appoints the Chairmen of all the Committees and supervises their functioning.

The Deputy Speaker

The Deputy Speaker is also elected by the members of the Assembly from amongst themselves. He performs the duties and responsibilities of the Speaker as his absence and presides over the Assembly in the absence of the Speaker. The deputy Speaker has also powers on par with the Speaker within the House. Any member existing in a panel can preside over the House in case of absence of Speaker and the deputy Speaker.

Committees of the Parliament

Broadly, parliamentary Committees are of two kinds - Standing Committee and Ad Hoc Committees. The former are permanent (constituted every year or periodically) and work on a continuous basis, while the latter are temporary and cease to exist on completion of the task assigned to them.

Standing Committees

On the basis of the nature of functions performed by them, standing Committees can be classified into the following six categories:

1. Financial Committees

a) Public Accounts Committee
b) Estimates Committee
c) Committee on Public Undertakings

2. Departmental Standing Committees (24)

3. Committees to Inquire

a) Committee on Petitions
b) Committee of Privileges
c) Ethics Committee

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